



MANIFESTO

So that you don't have to be desperate to begin

Young Koreans have nowhere that gives them
what this event is trying to give. So we become that door.

This document sets down what we came together for, and what
stays the same no matter what else changes.

NARU

September 2026, Singapore

v1. Every round and every rule that follows is measured against this document

1,000+

Korean students in Singapore

0

student bodies that have represented them

Nobody senior passes anything down. Nobody who graduates leaves anything behind. Everyone is on their own. Is there something romantic in that? I am not sure there is.

Other communities on the same campuses already have this. They share what they know, make room for each other, and pull the younger ones up. We are strong one by one, and scattered the moment we step outside.

At the same time the world is far too competitive, so people get fixed on milestones. Grades, internships, graduation, the offer. Filling the next box leaves no time for the larger question. Where can I actually go? How many directions are open in front of me?

Exploring takes a safe place. Somewhere failure is not recorded, being bad at something is not judged, and not knowing can be said out loud. Somewhere you can put everything else down and do nothing but learn. Students abroad have nowhere like that.

So we are laying the bridge
we wish had been there for us.

The two that do not change

CORE 01

A safe place to try something new

안전하게 도전할 수 있는 공간

No screening. No ranking. It is a place where you are allowed to be bad at it. Nothing you did poorly here is written down anywhere. What stays is that you saw it through.

CORE 02

A chance to prove your own worth

자기 가치를 증명해보는 경험

Not a rehearsal. We put you in front of the real thing. A company with its name on it, someone who actually does the work, a problem with no settled answer. You build something on your own judgement, explain it at the level of the person listening, and walk out holding proof that it happened.

A community grows when the barrier is low, and it matures when there are role models. With only one of the two it collapses into a social club or an elite club. Holding both at once is this group's work, and judging which way to lean when they pull against each other is the skill.

III How we stand

01 We build bridges, not walls

A circle that only feeds itself is something to guard against. But people who share a language and a history building a common agenda and some bargaining power is a different thing. The first puts up a wall. The second lays a bridge. We do the second.

02 We do not stand as underdogs

This is not a room we gather in to prove we were wronged. The order runs the other way. Build a real stage first, then look at who did well on it, and it turns out to be us.

03 We do not filter at the door. We notice quickly once you are inside

This is not a place that picks people who are already good. The door stays open to beginners. What we do instead is spot the ones who shine early and put them up as role models. Role models are not something you go and find. They are something you make.

04 Stories travel through people

A community's story travels through people, not through programmes or institutions. "Korean students started something like this" does not travel nearly as far as "this student came out of there." When we explain ourselves we put a person in front, not an organisation.

IV What changes

The event is only one of the ways these values get carried out.

AI, FDE, whatever comes after. The agenda moves with the situation. What a younger generation needs to learn moves as the world moves, and the event can follow. The format is the same. Eight days can become four. A builderthon can become something else entirely.

Only two things must not change. When you are unsure what to do, ask this. Does it widen the space to try safely? Does it give someone a chance to prove their own worth? If the answer to both is no, then however timely it is, it is not ours.

V Why we build it anyway

You can make your own opportunities. That is true. Proving your worth is your own job too.

But that effort takes practice, and mine started in desperation. I knocked on doors because I had to, and knocking taught me how. Still, why should that be the only feeling you are allowed to start from? It would have been better to learn it in first or second year. So we are moving that place earlier.

If you make opportunities, you run into this. People who are not grateful for what you made. People who take only the best of what you can give. They will be there.

Even if some people never make
the most of it, the door has to exist.

There are people looking for the same thing. Having the means to build a place where they can prove themselves and not building it would be wrong. Closing the door on the many because a few were not grateful is going back to the state we resented when it was not there.

VI On the process

It is easy to believe the process only matters once the result arrives. Planning something like this, a moment always comes when the result is uncertain and the process is far too heavy.

But every result is one point in the longer process that is a life. That is probably what connecting the dots means. Where the dot you are placing now leads cannot be known now. The line is only visible looking back.

So I hope you enjoy this process. Enjoying it does not mean it will not be hard. It means knowing this time is already worth something before any result shows up.

Which is why this team has to be built by people who mean it about the process.

For someone who only needs the result, this work is too long and too uncertain.

VII The people who will build this

01 Do not do it alone

Carry the stress alone and you start hoping somebody will notice. When that hope goes unmet you begin to resent the people who came to the place you made, and you stop giving them the best you have. Not doing it alone is not a virtue. It is a rule.

02 Do not hide your arithmetic

Everyone is allowed something in it for themselves. They should have it. It only must not exceed what they can give to others, and the arithmetic has to be something you can say out loud to the people building it with you. If you cannot say it, the arithmetic is wrong.

03 Do not leave the person who set the table out of the settlement

If everyone takes something home from a place and only the person who made it takes nothing, that place happens once. The team has to know who is spending time and money and their own name on it, and saying so must never count as complaining.

VIII What a round has to leave behind

**The most important output of a round
is not what got built. It is a person's story.**

What comes out of a demo day is consumed on the spot and mostly forgotten. What stays is the story of the one or two first role models that round produced, and writing it down is the thing that has to happen every single round.

That record becomes the recruiting for the next round, the case we make to companies, and years later almost the only evidence of what this group was.

Culture is made the same way. It becomes culture only once somebody is seen giving back what they received. So we always keep a place for the person who received to come back and give. Making that scene happen, writing it down and putting it where people can see it. That is where a round ends.

IX What comes after this document

This manifesto writes down the **why**. The constitution that follows writes down the **how**.

The constitution is not there to discipline anyone. It is there to flatten the complexity of this work as far as it will go, so the right person can find the seat that matches where they want to go, so the difficulty and the worry are carried by several people instead of one, and so each person's own arithmetic actually comes out right because the roles are properly explained.

When roles are not explained, the work piles onto one person and everything above collapses.

Building a culture takes five years.

One person gets a year at most.

So this group is designed for succession from the beginning. People leaving is not an accident, it is the default, and building what survives the change is half of what we do. The first thing a new person reads should be this document. Change the agenda freely. Changing the two cores is the same act as rewriting this document.

And one day, I hope the reason to come to Singapore is not Singapore itself, but that this is where you get to do something like this.

LAST

Every one of us can live
as someone's role model,
and already does.

I do not want these values kept only inside the group. Making a safe place for someone else. Trying to prove your own worth. Not doing it alone. Not hiding your arithmetic. I hope what you practise here you also do in your own life.

Then this group will have left people behind, not events.

This group is called **NARU**. In Korean it is the landing where someone crossing a river takes the boat. The crossing is yours to make. NARU builds the place where crossing is possible, and the place a person who crossed comes back to stand is the same NARU.

NARU
SEPTEMBER 2026, SINGAPORE